

parties. You'll also want to save any receipts used to repair or maintain the property, and keep good records in case a disagreement ever arises.

5. BRING IN A ROOMMATE

If subletting is allowed, see if you can bring in a roommate to offset costs. Some landlords may add a fee for extra utility usage, but the benefits might be worth the added expense.

The best option to find a roommate is to check with friends or family members who are in transition and need a place to crash for a few months. For those that don't mind rooming with a stranger, [Roommates.com](https://www.roommates.com) can send you potential matches. Just make sure your spouse or significant other is on board before offering an invite.

If you do find someone who is willing to split the rent, there's actually one of two ways to make an agreement. Either divide everything equally between the two (bills, rent, food, etc.), or sublet and rent the place to your roommate. This means you pay for everything, but charge your roommate a set amount. Both work, but if you're looking for less hassle and fewer arguments, choose the latter. Be very careful, though, as subletting is commonly prohibited in many leases.

6. FIND ANOTHER PLACE

If all else fails and you're not able to handle your monthly payment anymore, you should probably look for another place. I know how much of a pain it is to move, but if you can save \$100/month and plan on renting for at least another year, that's \$1,200 in savings!

The best places to look for apartments online are Craigslist, Trulia, and Zillow. You can also check your local paper, and of course, collect recommendations from friends and family. Keep surrounding towns and cities in mind too—a less expensive area might have a longer commute, but the trade-off could be worth it depending on price.